

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS

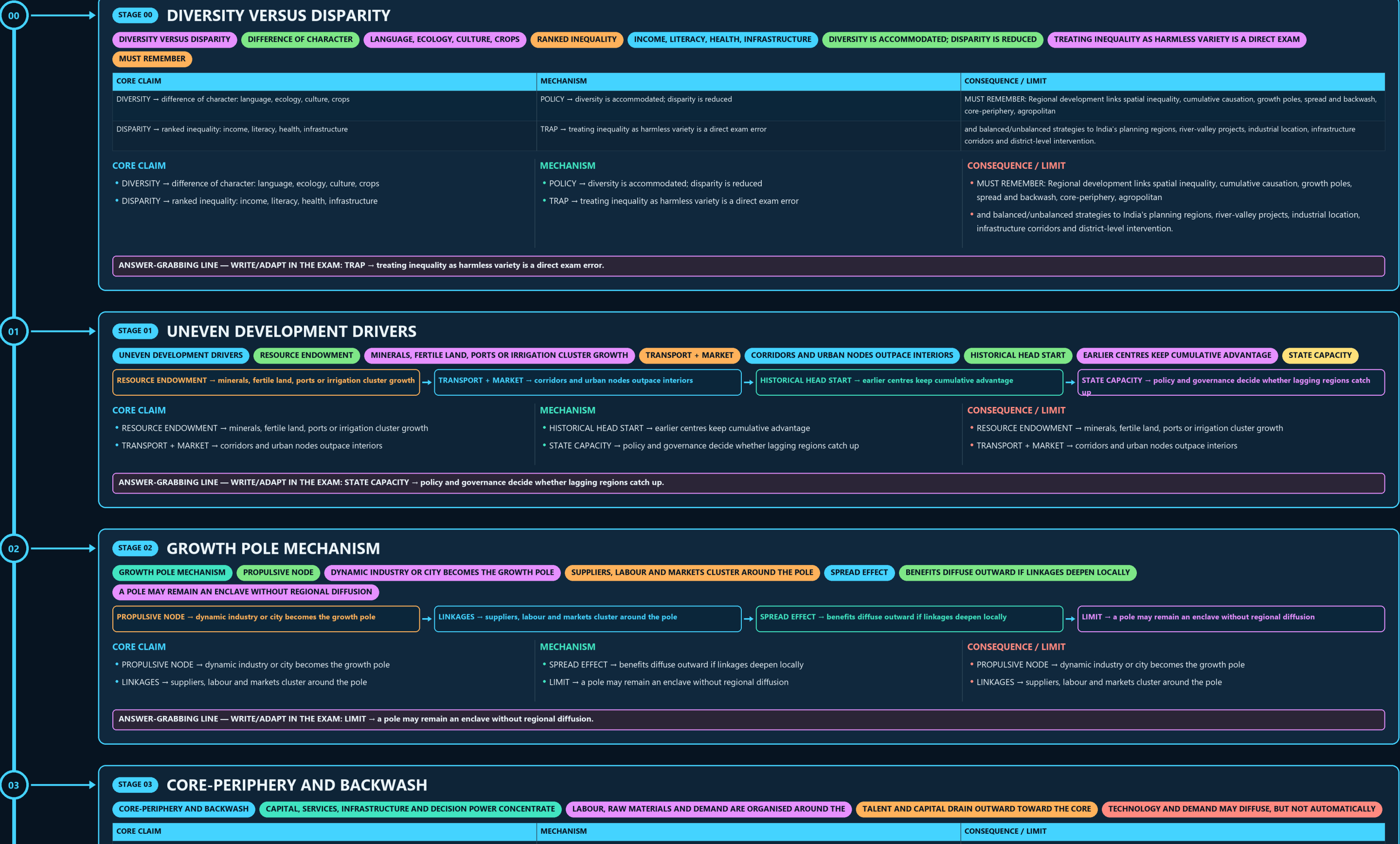
DIVERSITY VERSUS DISPARITY → UNEVEN DEVELOPMENT DRIVERS → GROWTH POLE MECHANISM → CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH → PLANNING REGION CRITERIA → INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles



03

• LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

• LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion

• LINKAGES → suppliers, labour and markets cluster around the pole

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a pole may remain an enclave without regional diffusion.

04

STAGE 03

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

CORE-PERIPHERY AND BACKWASH

CAPITAL, SERVICES, INFRASTRUCTURE AND DECISION POWER CONCENTRATE

LABOUR, RAW MATERIALS AND DEMAND ARE ORGANISED AROUND THE

TALENT AND CAPITAL DRAIN OUTWARD TOWARD THE CORE

TECHNOLOGY AND DEMAND MAY DIFFUSE, BUT NOT AUTOMATICALLY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate	BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core	CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate
PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core	SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically	PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

CORE CLAIM

• CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate

• PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

MECHANISM

• BACKWASH → talent and capital drain outward toward the core

• SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• CORE → capital, services, infrastructure and decision power concentrate

• PERIPHERY → labour, raw materials and demand are organised around the core

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SPREAD → technology and demand may diffuse, but not automatically.

05

STAGE 04

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

PLANNING REGION CRITERIA

FUNCTIONAL UNITY

FLows AND LINKAGES HOLD THE REGION TOGETHER

ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY

POLICY MUST ACTUALLY BE IMPLEMENTABLE

ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY

STRATEGY AND RESOURCE BASE MUST ALIGN

SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together	ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align	FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together
ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable	SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success	ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

CORE CLAIM

• FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together

• ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

MECHANISM

• ECONOMIC + ECOLOGICAL VIABILITY → strategy and resource base must align

• SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• FUNCTIONAL UNITY → flows and linkages hold the region together

• ADMINISTRATIVE MANAGEABILITY → policy must actually be implementable

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOCIAL ACCEPTABILITY → regional identity and needs affect success.

06

STAGE 05

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

INDIAN PLANNING TIMELINE

NATIONAL PLANNING COMMITTEE BEGINS THE PLANNING IMAGINATION

PLANNING COMMISSION SET UP AND FIRST PLAN LAUNCHED

ANNUAL PLANS AFTER WAR, DROUGHT AND MACRO STRESS

TWELFTH PLAN LAST CYCLE; NITI REPLACES PLANNING COMMISSION

1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination

1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress

2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination	1966-69 → Annual Plans after war, drought and macro stress	1938 → National Planning Committee begins the planning imagination
1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched	2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission	1950-51 → Planning Commission set up and First Plan launched

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2012-17 / 2015 → Twelfth Plan last cycle; NITI replaces Planning Commission.

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STAGE 06

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLAN

FIRST PLAN

IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWER

SECOND PLAN

HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASE

SPATIAL LOGIC

AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT

DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power	SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next	FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base	TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans	SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

CORE CLAIM

• FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power

• SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

MECHANISM

• SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next

• TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

• FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power

• SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT AND FIVE YEAR PLANS • TILE 2/4 • same master rows 2691-5925 of 11308 • continues below

FIRST VERSUS SECOND PLANFIRST PLAN → IRRIGATION, AGRICULTURE, REFUGEE RESETTLEMENT, POWERSECOND PLAN → HEAVY INDUSTRY AND PUBLIC-SECTOR INDUSTRIAL BASESPATIAL LOGIC → AGRARIAN RECOVERY FIRST, INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION NEXT

DO NOT SWAP THE PRIORITIES OF THE TWO PLANS

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CORE CLAIM

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
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MECHANISM

- SPATIAL LOGIC → agrarian recovery first, industrial concentration next
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CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- FIRST PLAN → irrigation, agriculture, refugee resettlement, power
- SECOND PLAN → heavy industry and public-sector industrial base

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → do not swap the priorities of the two plans.

STAGE 07WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTED

WHY IMBALANCE PERSISTEDUNEVEN IRRIGATION → GREEN REVOLUTION GAINS STAYED REGIONALLY SELECTIVEINDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → PORTS, METROS AND CORRIDORS PULLED AHEADCONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → INTERIORS REMAINED INFRASTRUCTURE-POOR

BALANCED REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT STAYED INCOMPLETE

UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selectiveINDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled aheadCONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poorOUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective	CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor	UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead	OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete	INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

CORE CLAIM

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

MECHANISM

- CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor
- OUTCOME → balanced regional development stayed incomplete

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- UNEVEN IRRIGATION → Green Revolution gains stayed regionally selective
- INDUSTRIAL CONCENTRATION → ports, metros and corridors pulled ahead

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONNECTIVITY + GOVERNANCE GAPS → interiors remained infrastructure-poor.

STAGE 08PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITI

PLANNING COMMISSION VERSUS NITIPLANNING COMMISSION → CENTRALISED PLAN FORMULATION AND OUTLAY LOGICNITI AAYOG → THINK-TANK COORDINATION, COMPETITIVE AND COOPERATIVE FEDERALISMPPLAN DOCUMENTS → LONG-HORIZON ALLOCATION FRAMEWORK

INDICATOR MONITORING AND MISSION-MODE COMPARISON

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic	PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework	PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism	DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison	NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

CORE CLAIM

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

MECHANISM

- PLAN DOCUMENTS → long-horizon allocation framework
- DASHBOARDS → indicator monitoring and mission-mode comparison

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- PLANNING COMMISSION → centralised plan formulation and outlay logic
- NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NITI AAYOG → think-tank coordination, competitive and cooperative federalism.

STAGE 09DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDER

DISTRICT AND BLOCK TARGETING LADDERSTATE AVERAGE → USEFUL BUT HIDES INTERNAL INEQUALITYDISTRICT TARGETING → ASPIRATIONAL DISTRICTS BRINGS LAGGING DISTRICTS INTO FOCUSBLOCK TARGETING → SCALE MOVES FURTHER DOWNWARD WHERE DISTRICT AVERAGES STILL HIDE

GEOGRAPHIC LESSON

STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality

DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focusBLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gapsGEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality	GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem	plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.
DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus	CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning	
BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps	Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015	

CORE CLAIM

- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus
- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps

MECHANISM

- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning
- Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015; plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

CORE CLAIM

- STATE AVERAGE → useful but hides internal inequality
- DISTRICT TARGETING → Aspirational Districts brings lagging districts into focus
- BLOCK TARGETING → scale moves further downward where district averages still hide gaps

MECHANISM

- GEOGRAPHIC LESSON → intra-state disparity is a first-order planning problem
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Five Year Plans ended after the Twelfth Plan period and the Planning
- Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog in 2015; plan strategy, Finance Commission transfers, centrally sponsored schemes, NITI cooperative/competitive federalism and constitutional local planning are institutionally distinct.

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STAGE 10

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKING

SDG-STYLE BENCHMARKINGSDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24OVERALL INDIA SCORE 71TERRITORIAL INDICATORSDEVELOPMENT IS RANKED SPATIALLY, NOT ONLY NATIONALLYCURRENT STYLEDASHBOARDS COMPLEMENT MISSIONS AND PROGRAMME CONVERGENCESAFE USE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71	SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity	convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.
TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally	EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions,	
CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence	Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity	

CORE CLAIM

- SDG INDIA INDEX 2023-24 → overall India score 71
- TERRITORIAL INDICATORS → development is ranked spatially, not only nationally
- CURRENT STYLE → dashboards complement missions and programme convergence

MECHANISM

- SAFE USE → planning changed form, but not the geography of disparity
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Damodar Valley, NCR, Dandakaranya, command areas, hill/tribal regions,
- Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aspirational Districts and freight/industrial corridors show that growth-node benefits depend on linkages, displacement, skills, ecology and state capacity; convergence is an empirical result, not an automatic consequence of investment.

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STAGE 11

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINE

REGIONAL DEVELOPMENT ANSWER SPINEDISPARITY VERSUS DIVERSITY AND THE MEANING OF REGIONAL PLANNINGGROWTH POLE, CORE-PERIPHERY, SPREAD AND BACKWASH1938 COMMITTEE, FIRST PLAN, SECOND PLAN, NITI TRANSITION

DISTRICT DASHBOARDS MATTER BECAUSE STATE AVERAGES CONCEAL DISPARITY

DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning

EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition

QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CORE CLAIM

- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

MECHANISM

- TRACE → 1938 committee, First Plan, Second Plan, NITI transition
- QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT

- DEFINE → disparity versus diversity and the meaning of regional planning
- EXPLAIN → growth pole, core-periphery, spread and backwash

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → district dashboards matter because state averages conceal disparity.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTONE INTERPRETATION SAYS INDIA HAS MOVED FROM CENTRALISED FIVE-YEARANOTHER SAYS THE UNDERLYING ISSUE REMAINS THE SAMEHOW TO REDUCEREGIONAL IMBALANCE IN LAGGING DISTRICTS, SMALL TOWNS, TRIBAL BELTS

A GOOD MAINS ANSWER SHOULD THEREFORE TREAT NITI AS

THE PLANNING COMMISSION WAS REPLACED BY NITI AAYOG ON

THE TWELFTH PLAN WAS THE LAST FIVE-YEAR PLAN CYCLE.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- CAUTION: One interpretation says India has moved from centralised Five-Year Plans to more flexible mission-based and state-compared governance.
- CAUTION: Another says the underlying issue remains the same: how to reduce
- regional imbalance in lagging districts, small towns, tribal belts and infrastructure-poor interiors.
- CAUTION: A good Mains answer should therefore treat NITI as a change in planning style, not the end of planning geography.

ADVANCED DEBATE

- The Planning Commission was replaced by NITI Aayog on 1 January 2015.
- The Twelfth Plan was the last Five-Year Plan cycle.
- Balanced regional development remained an explicit concern but an incomplete achievement.
- Aspirational Districts Programme targets districts, not states as a whole.

LEGACY / NUANCE

- SDG India Index is a territorial-development benchmarking tool.
- NOT: NITI Aayog is simply the Planning Commission with a new name - The institutional style and policy mechanism changed significantly.
- NOT: Ending Five-Year Plans ended planning - Planning continues through missions, indices, state coordination and targeted programmes.
- NOT: Regional imbalance is only about poor states - It also exists within states, between districts and between metros and hinterlands.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.